Saturday 24 October 2026, SLB Championship

London Lions *v* Bristol Flyers

18:00

Copper Box Arena, Queen Elizabeth Olympic Park, London E20 3HB

London Lions		Bristol Flyers
1st, 6–0	Record	2nd, 4–2
W W L W W	Last five	W L W W W
W 89–72 at U-BT Cluj-Napoca, Wed 21 Oct	Last game	W 90–89 v Liverpool Basketball, Sun 18 Oct
Kennedy 11.5	Top scorer	Bailey 18.3
Scott 4.8	Rebounds	Holden 6.5
Soluade 4.2	Assists	Holden 4.5
Horton 2.0 of 4.6	Threes a game	Bailey 2.8 of 7.3
Williams 1.5	Steals	Anderson 1.3, Jennings 1.3
80	Last meeting	78

Six wins from six in the SLB Championship and fresh off a win in Romania, the Lions welcome the side that sits second, Bristol Flyers, to the Copper Box Arena. Bristol are 4–2, and they were the closest to London in September, when the Lions won 80–78 at the SGS College Arena.

It is a week of change in the Lions backcourt, with Keenan Evans recalled to Žalgiris Kaunas, and a Bristol side led by Davion Bailey's 18.3 points a game. Here is what to know before tip-off.

Form *6–0 in the SLB, 2–2 in the EuroCup*

The Lions beat Cheshire Phoenix 87–83 on the road on Sunday 18 October. After a back-and-forth first half they closed it with a 10–0 run to lead 45–35 at the break, then had to withstand a series of Cheshire runs after the interval. Landrius Horton led the scoring with 17 points, shooting 4/5 from three, with Tarik Phillip and Thomas Kennedy adding 14 each. After Cheshire made it a one-point game with 13 seconds left, Joel Scott was fouled and made both free throws.

Three days later they won 89–72 at U-BT Cluj-Napoca to move to 2–2 in the EuroCup. London trailed 22–21 after the first quarter and led 40–37 at half-time before taking control after the interval, using defensive pressure and efficient scoring. Head coach Tautvydas Sabonis pointed to the defence: “Our defence, 72 points is crazy,” said Sabonis.

The EuroCup has not been all smooth. The Lions beat La Laguna Tenerife 89–77 at home on 6 October, then lost 81–76 to Skyliners Frankfurt at home on 15 October. In the league, they edged Leicester Riders 71–66 on 2 October.

Wed 21 Oct EuroCup at U-BT Cluj-Napoca	W 89–72
Sun 18 Oct SLB at Cheshire Phoenix	W 87–83
Thu 15 Oct EuroCup v Skyliners Frankfurt	L 76–81
Tue 6 Oct EuroCup v La Laguna Tenerife	W 89–77
Fri 2 Oct SLB v Leicester Riders	W 71–66

Highlights

LONDON LIONS HANDLE BUSINESS IN CLUJ MOVING TO 2-2 in EUROCUP
Wed 21 Oct

Lions roster *and who to watch*

Thomas Kennedy
Season: 11.5 pts, 4.7 reb, 2.2 ast, 19 min

The Lions' leading scorer on 11.5 points a game. He scored 16 at Cluj, shooting 7/7 from two-point range, and had 14 points, three assists and three steals at Cheshire.

Landrius Horton
Season: 9.8 pts, 2.0 reb, 2.8 ast, 23 min

Averages 9.8 points and is the Lions' leading three-point shooter, making two of 4.6 attempts a game. He went 4/5 from deep for his 17 at Cheshire, and added a step-back jumper in the closing minutes.

Devante Jones
Season: 9.4 pts, 1.2 reb, 3.6 ast, 21 min

Averages 9.4 points and 3.6 assists. At Cluj he finished with 14 points, five rebounds, four assists and three steals, and made both free throws when Cluj cut the deficit to 10.

Joel Scott
Season: 10.4 pts, 4.8 reb, 1.6 ast, 23 min

Averages 10.4 points and leads the Lions with 4.8 rebounds a game. He added 15 points and five rebounds at Cluj, and his two free throws late at Cheshire pushed the lead back out.

Tarik Phillip
Season: 8.2 pts, 4.0 reb, 2.6 ast, 20 min

Averages 8.2 points, 4 rebounds and 2.6 assists. At Cheshire he had 14 points, seven assists and four rebounds, and helped lead the 10–0 run that closed the first half.

Full roster

1	Joel Scott	C/F
2	Maxwell Lewis III	F
3	Devante Jones	G
6	Morayo Soluade	F
7	Joshua O'Garro	F
8	Emilis Zibuda	F
10	Ethan Price	C/F
21	Aaryn Rai	F
22	Tarik Phillip	G
23	Landrius Horton	F/G
31	Deane Williams	C/F
54	Thomas Kennedy	C

Injury and availability

Keenan Evans will not be in the Lions squad. The club confirmed on Friday that he is returning to Žalgiris Kaunas following his loan, after being recalled because of an injury to Žalgiris guard Nigel Williams-Goss. Evans made four appearances in both EuroCup and SLB Championship play, averaging 9.8 points and 3.5 assists in the SLB Championship. He scored 12 points at Cluj on Wednesday.

General Manager Martynas Purlys said: "Having Keenan Evans with us has been a great opportunity. He brought quality, experience and leadership to our backcourt, and we wish him all the best as he returns to Žalgiris Kaunas."

Bristol Flyers *second, 4–2*

Bristol have won four of six in the league. Their losses are to the Lions and, on 25 September, 94–68 at Newcastle Eagles. Since then they beat Manchester Basketball 76–58 at home, won 78–73 at Leicester Riders and then edged Liverpool Basketball 90–89 on Sunday. That one was settled at the line: Davion Bailey's lefty lay-in put the Flyers one up with 16 seconds left, and Liverpool's Damiri Lindo missed two free throws with just over a second to play.

Bristol's recap singled out the pairing of Matteus Case and Kasen Jennings in the backcourt as dynamic, and the forward combination of Mike Diggins Jr and Zach Anderson for keeping them in touch in the first half. Head coach Andreas Kapoulas and Cam Holden were on the club podcast this week looking back on the one-point win.

Davion Bailey

Season: 18.3 pts, 3.2 reb, 2.3 ast, 28 min

Bristol's leading scorer on 18.3 points a game, and he shoots plenty: 7.3 three-point attempts a game, of which he makes 2.8. He had 17 points, six assists, five rebounds and three steals against Liverpool.

Cameron Holden

Season: 9.2 pts, 6.5 reb, 4.5 ast, 25 min

The guard averages 9.2 points, leads the team with 6.5 rebounds and 4.5 assists a game, and plays 25 minutes.

Michael Diggins Jr

Season: 12.2 pts, 5.5 reb, 1.2 ast, 29 min

The forward averages 12.2 points and 5.5 rebounds in 29 minutes a game.

Zachary Anderson

Season: 9.7 pts, 5.0 reb, 1.7 ast, 30 min

Averages 9.7 points, 5 rebounds and 1.3 steals in 30 minutes a game. Bristol's recap credited his run in the first quarter against Liverpool.

Matteus Case

Season: 10.0 pts, 1.8 reb, 1.0 ast, 14 min

Scores 10 points a game in 14 minutes, off the bench.

Last five

Sun 18 Oct SLB v Liverpool Basketball	W 90–89
Fri 9 Oct SLB at Leicester Riders	W 78–73
Fri 2 Oct SLB v Manchester Basketball	W 76–58
Fri 25 Sept SLB at Newcastle Eagles	L 68–94
Sun 20 Sept SLB at Cheshire Phoenix	W 101–92

Full roster

0	Cameron Holden	G
1	Zac Triplett	G
2	Michael Diggins Jr	F
4	Matteus Case	G
5	Davion Bailey	G
9	Dylan Wilkie	G
10	Zachary Anderson	F
13	Kasen Jennings	G
21	Marcus Delpeche	C/F
22	Malcolm Delpeche	C
24	Imam Toure	F
25	Milos Dugalic	F
99	Nojus Zajankauskas	G

Things to watch

- **The league's scorers.** Bailey leads Bristol on 18.3 points a game; Kennedy leads London on 11.5. The Lions spread the load more widely.
- **Without Evans.** Four of Evans's appearances came in the SLB, where he averaged 9.8 points and 3.5 assists. Soluade leads the team with 4.2 assists.
- **Late-game free throws.** Bristol's win over Liverpool turned on two misses at the line, and the Lions' win at Cheshire on Scott's two.
- **Legs.** London played in Romania on Wednesday. Bristol's last league game was against Liverpool on 18 October.

Head to head *Lions by two in September*

18 Sept 2026 SLB at SGS College Arena	W 80–78

London won 80–78 at the SGS College Arena on 18 September, in Bristol's home arena. It is the only meeting this season.

League table

London top the table on 12 points from six games, with Bristol second on eight, level with Newcastle Eagles after six games each. At the bottom, Leicester Riders are 0–6.

#	Team	P	W	L	Pts
1	**London Lions**	**6**	**6**	**0**	**12**
2	**Bristol Flyers**	**6**	**4**	**2**	**8**
3	Newcastle Eagles	6	4	2	8
4	Caledonia Gladiators	5	3	2	6
5	Manchester Basketball	7	3	4	6
6	Sheffield Sharks	4	2	2	4
7	Cheshire Phoenix	5	2	3	4
8	Liverpool Basketball	5	2	3	4
9	Surrey 89ers	4	1	3	2
10	Leicester Riders	6	0	6	0

Notable stats

- Kennedy leads the Lions with 11.5 points a game; Scott has the most rebounds, 4.8, and Soluade the most assists, 4.2.
- Deane Williams leads the Lions in steals with 1.5 a game.
- Bristol's leaders: Bailey 18.3 points, Holden 6.5 rebounds and 4.5 assists, and Anderson and Jennings 1.3 steals each.
- The Lions have won every SLB game this season, 6–0, while Bristol are 4–2.

What's next

The Lions are home to Turk Telekom Ankara in the EuroCup on Wednesday 28 October, then host Sheffield Sharks in the SLB at New City College Hackney on Friday 30 October.

Wed 28 Oct, 19:30 EuroCup v Turk Telekom Ankara

Fri 30 Oct, 19:00 SLB v Sheffield Sharks (at New City College Hackney)

Wed 4 Nov, 19:30 EuroCup at Maxima Roma

Fri 6 Nov, 19:00 SLB v Leicester Riders (at New City College Hackney)

Sources

Genius Sports (SLB)

SLB Championship standings

Lions roster

Bristol Flyers summary

Bristol Flyers roster

Lions player statistics

Bristol Flyers player statistics

Lions SLB Championship fixtures and results

EuroLeague

EuroCup games

YouTube

London Lions channel feed

London Lions

KEENAN EVANS RETURNS TO ŽALGIRIS KAUNAS, 23 Oct 2026

LIONS EDGE CHESHIRE 87-83 TO EXTEND UNBEATEN SLB START TO 6-0, 18 Oct 2026

LIONS DOMINATE SECOND HALF TO BEAT CLUJ 89-72 ON THE ROAD, 21 Oct 2026

Newham Recorder

London Lions enjoy winning weekend as men remain unbeaten and women get off the mark, 19 Oct 2026

Bristol Flyers

Game Recap: Bristol Flyers 90-89 Liverpool Basketball | SLB Championship, 18 Oct 2026

The podcast goes courtside | The Bristol Flyers Podcast, 23 Oct 2026

Gathered 24 Oct 2026 at 08:20.